Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary today are given in loving memory of our dear friend, Callie Pounders.

Though we miss you more than words can say, we find comfort knowing you are resting in the arms of Jesus. Until we meet again, you will always be remembered, deeply missed, and forever loved.

"The faithful love of the Lord never ends! His mercies never cease. Great is his faithfulness; his mercies begin afresh each morning." — Lamentations 3:22–23

Forever in our hearts, Anna, Ben & Chandler Erwin

Announcements

37th Community Thanksgiving Meal. Join us on Thanksgiving morning, Thursday, November 26, as we prepare and deliver 750 Thanksgiving meals to those who need them throughout Alcorn County. This is a HUGE project and can only be accomplished with the help of many. It is a great opportunity for the members of FPC to be disciples by "living and loving like Jesus." Please complete the insert to volunteer your time and place it in the offering plate, or bring it to the church office.

Every Member Canvass. If you haven't already done so, please complete one of the paper forms available at the Narthex and East entrances, or scan the QR code on the back of the pews.

Samaritan's Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children's wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs $10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. John Shipp
Greeters — Courtney & Ivy Monaghan
Acolytes — Jack Windsor & Will Sanders
Circle of Prayer — Jason & Jennifer LeGoff
Children's Church — Jennifer Shipp
AV Engineer — Russell Smith
Ushers — Scott Sawyer, Holland Yeates, Ben Long, & Josh McCahill
Nursery — Laura Kate Carmichiel, Jackie Capps, Morgan Williams, Maribel Albarran, & Joshua & Brittany Bryant

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women's Min. & Comm.
Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malechi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

November 1 Session Meeting
November 3 Messy Bible Study, 8 a.m. · Election Day (Fellowship Hall in use) · No Day School
November 4 Kids Quest · Youth House · Messy Bible Study, 6 p.m.
November 5 First Thursday at the Youth House, noon
November 8 Deacons' Meeting
November 26 37th Community Thanksgiving Meal

Online Giving

Scan to give online

919 East Shiloh Rd · Corinth, MS 38834 · fpccorinth.org · 662-286-6638

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

November 1, 2026

Twenty-third Sunday after Pentecost

"To be disciples, to make disciples"

A congregation of the Evangelical Presbyterian Church

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children's Church during the service. Children's bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God's Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by "Being Disciples and Making Disciples."

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Notes

"Spiritual Renewal: When God Begins to Work"

Rev. Waring Porter · Nehemiah 1:1–11

Welcome back to the story of God's restoration. In the book of Ezra we saw a temple rebuilt and a community rooted again in the Word of God. We are going to keep going in the story and get into the Book of Nehemiah — in the Jewish Bible, Ezra and Nehemiah are one book. As we open the Book of Nehemiah, we discover that a beautiful house of worship is not enough if the city around it lies in ruins and the people inside are living in fear. Nehemiah takes us from the quiet halls of a Persian palace in Babylon to the rubble of a broken Jerusalem, shifting our focus from architectural reconstruction to a deep, messy, and urgent spiritual renewal.

The temple had been rebuilt, but Jerusalem's walls still lay in ruins. God's people had returned to the land, but they remained vulnerable and exposed. There had been real restoration, but there was still work to be done.

As we look at the first chapter of Nehemiah we see how God begins His work of restoration: by awakening His people to the brokenness around them and drawing them to Himself in prayer. Nehemiah 1 shows us where and how that work begins.

I. God Awakens His People *(vv. 1–4)*

II. God Draws His People to Himself *(vv. 5–10)*

> *Daniel 9:18 — "For we do not present our pleas before you because of our righteousness, but because of your great mercy."*

III. God Prepares His People *(v. 11)*

Scripture Reading *Nehemiah 1:1–11 · Pew Bible, p. 398*

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8
Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: *The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.*

Sermon: *"Spiritual Renewal: When God Begins to Work"* *Rev. Waring Porter*

Prayer of Commitment

SENDING

***Hymn: #43** *"Great Is Thy Faithfulness"*

***Benediction**

BENEDICTION
God's people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. This should remind us that God doesn't just meet with us when we gather, but He goes with us as we scatter. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

***Choral Benediction** *"Sevenfold Amen"*

***Postlude**

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

November 1, 2026

** Indicates congregation standing if able*

GATHERING

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Lamentations 3:22–23
"The steadfast love of the Lord never ceases; his mercies never come to an end; they are new every morning; great is your faithfulness."

PRELUDE
The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God's presence.

The Prelude

Choral Introit *"We Come to Praise"*

***Call to Worship:** Psalm 103:1–2, 20–22 (NIV)
Leader: Praise the Lord, O my soul, all my inmost being, praise his holy name!
All: *Praise the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits,*
Leader: Praise the Lord, O you his angels, you mighty ones who do his bidding, who obey his word.
All: *Praise the Lord, all his heavenly hosts, you his servants who do his will!*
Leader: Praise the Lord, all his works everywhere in his dominion.
All: *Praise the Lord, O my soul!*

***The Hymn: #10** *"O Worship the King"*

O WORSHIP THE KING
This beautiful hymn, written by Sir Robert Grant, a British politician and hymn writer, was published in 1833. Inspired by Psalm 104, the hymn celebrates God's majesty, power, and steadfast love. As we worship our great and holy King, we are reminded of our dependence upon His grace, leading us to confess our sins and trust in His covenant mercy.

INVOCATION
The word "invocation" suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To "invoke" is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

CALL TO CONFESSION
In Daniel 9, we hear a humble confession of God's people, acknowledging His righteousness, their sin, and their need for mercy. As we read responsively, we join in this prayer of repentance, remembering that our hope rests not in our own righteousness, but in God's steadfast covenant love and forgiveness.

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord's Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***Scriptural Call to Confession:** taken from Daniel 9

Leader: I prayed to the Lord my God and made confession, saying, "O Lord, the great and awesome God, who keeps covenant and steadfast love with those who love him and keep his commandments,

All: *We have sinned and done wrong and acted wickedly and rebelled, turning aside from your commandments and rules.*

Leader: To you, O Lord, belongs righteousness, but to us open shame, as at this day, to the men of Judah, to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to all Israel, those who are near and those who are far away, in all the lands to which you have driven them, because of the treachery that they have committed against you.

All: *To us, O Lord, belongs open shame, to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers, because we have sinned against you. To the Lord our God belong mercy and forgiveness, for we have rebelled against him and have not obeyed the voice of the Lord our God by walking in his laws, which he set before us by his servants the prophets.*

Leader: And now, O Lord our God, who brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, and have made a name for yourself, as at this day, we have sinned, we have done wickedly. Now therefore, O our God, listen to the prayer of your servant and to his pleas for mercy, and for your own sake, O Lord, make your face to shine upon your sanctuary, which is desolate.

All: *O my God, incline your ear and hear. Open your eyes and see our desolations, and the city that is called by your name. For we do not present our pleas before you because of our righteousness, but because of your great mercy.*

Leader: O Lord, hear; O Lord, forgive. O Lord, pay attention and act. Delay not, for your own sake, O my God, because your city and your people are called by your name.

All: *Lord, we have sinned against you, yet you are merciful and forgiving. Hear us as we confess our sins, and restore us according to your steadfast love.*

***Corporate Prayer of Confession**

Holy and gracious Father, You are righteous in all Your ways, yet we have sinned against You in thought, word, and deed. We have turned from Your commands, neglected Your Word, and loved our own ways more than Yours. We confess that we have not loved You with our whole hearts or loved our neighbors as ourselves. Forgive us, O Lord, not because of our righteousness, but according to Your great mercy. Restore us by Your grace, renew our hearts, and make us faithful to Your calling, that Your name might be honored among Your people.

Silent Confession

***Hymn of Response: #2** *"Come, Thou Fount of Every Blessing"*

***Assurance of Divine Pardon:** 1 John 1:9

"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."

WORD

Monthly Missionary Focus — *Courtney Monaghan, Missions Committee Member*

FPC MISSIONS
FPC currently provides prayer and financial support to over 50 international and domestic missionaries, along with 2 international ministry organizations and 6 local ministries. We want to introduce the congregation to several of these missionaries every month, so you can get to know them and pray specifically for them.

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem — *"That I May Know Thee"*, *Elizabeth Beckham*

***The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication**

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

***Children Dismissed to Children's Church**

CHILDREN'S CHURCH
Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children's Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.